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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TALCUM POWDER; PLAIN

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 This specification covers one type and one grade of talcum powder for personal use (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-C-96—Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter.
PPP-C-186—Containers, Packaging and Packing for Drugs, Chemicals, and Pharmaceuticals.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publication. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Department of Health, Education, and Welfare:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C., 20402.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample. When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample shall be submitted to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection and approval in accordance with 3.1.1. Approval of the pre-

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production sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured by the supplier in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 **Materials.** All materials used in formulation of the talcum powder shall conform to the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

3.3 **Composition.** Talcum powder shall consist of finely powdered talc (native magnesium silicate).

3.3.1 *pH.* The talcum powder shall be neutral when tested as specified in 4.3.3.

3.3.2 *Loss on ignition.* The maximum loss permitted on ignition shall be 5.0 percent.

3.4 **Color.** The color of the talcum powder shall be white. When specified, the color shall match a sample provided by the procuring activity.

3.5 **Odor.** The talcum powder shall be odorless or mildly fragrant.

3.6 **Fineness.** Not less than 98 percent of the talcum powder shall pass through a No. 200 U. S. Standard Sieve and not less than 100 percent shall pass through a No. 100 U. S. Standard Sieve when tested as specified in 4.3.3.

3.7 **Average net content.** The average net content per unit container shall be not less than specified.

3.8 **Workmanship.** The finished product shall be a clean, uniform powder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 **Responsibility for inspection.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 *Preproduction inspection.* When preproduction sample is specified, the sample shall be inspected and tested for conformance with the requirements of 4.3.1.1, 4.3.1.2 and 4.3.3.

4.2 **Inspection.** Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 *Component and material inspection.* In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents. The supplier shall submit to the contracting officer a certificate of compliance covering the material requirements contained in 3.2.

4.3 **Inspection of the end item.**

4.3.1 *Examination of the end item.* The end item and its preparation for delivery shall be examined for the defects in the applicable subparagraphs at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) set forth in 4.3.2. The lot size shall be expressed in unit containers of the specified capacity for the examinations in 4.3.1.1, 4.3.1 2 and 4.3.1.3 and in units of shipping containers for the examinations in 4.3.1.4.

4.3.1.1 *Examination of unit container.* The sample unit for this examination shall be one filled unit container.

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Examine	Defect
Construction	Not in container specified. Any split, break, hole, or puncture.
Closure	Not type specified. Any leakage of contents.
Markings	Not type specified. Missing, illegible, incorrect, or incomplete. Not in accordance with requirements (see 5.3).

4.3.1.2 *Examination of contents of the unit container.* The sample unit for this examination shall be the contents of one filled unit container.

Examine	Defect
Color	Not white or does not match reference sample as applicable.
Odor	Not mildly fragrant or odorless as applicable. Objectionable.
Workmanship	Not clean. Not uniform powder.

4.3.1 3 *Examination for average net contents.* The sample unit for this examination shall be one filled unit container.

Examine	Defect
Average net content	The average net content per container is less than specified.

4.3.1.4 *Examination of preparation for delivery.* An examination shall be made to determine that markings, materials, workmanship, and contents comply with the requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation. Closed shipping containers shall be examined for closure defects.

Examine	Defect
Marking, exterior or interior	Incorrect; illegible; omitted; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any nonconforming component; component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Contents	Number of unit containers per shipping container is more or less than specified.

4.3.2 *Inspection levels and AQLs for examination.* The inspection levels for determining the sample size and the AQLs expressed in defects per 100 units shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection level	AQLs
4.3.1.1	S-3	2.5
4.3.1.2	S-3	2.5
4.3.1.3	S-2	N.A.
4.3.1.4	S-1	2.5

4.3.3 *Testing of the end item.* The methods of testing specified in table I shall be followed for each lot. The lot size shall be expressed in pounds of talcum powder. The sample size shall be as specified following. The sample unit for testing shall be a one 8-ounce composite obtained by thoroughly mixing equal portions from the specimens selected at random throughout the lot in the frequency listed below. The lot shall be unacceptable if the composite sample fails to meet any of the test requirements specified. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result.

Lot size (pounds)	Sample frequency
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 or more	5

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TABLE I. *Instructions for testing of the end item*

Characteristic	Specification reference		Requirements applicable to		Number determinations per comp. samp.	Results reported as		Inspect. level	AQL
	Requirement	Test method	Samp. unit	Comp. samp.		Pass or fail	Numerically to nearest		
Talc identification	3.3	4.4.1		X	1	X			
pH	3.3.1	4.4.2		X	1	X			
Loss on ignition	3.3.2	4.4.3		X	Average of 2		0.1 percent		
Fineness	3.6	4.4.4		X	1	X			

4.4 Test procedures.

4.4.1 *Talc identification.* Mix 500 mg. of sample with about 200 mg. of anhydrous sodium carbonate and 2 g. of anhydrous potassium carbonate, and heat the mixture in a platinum crucible until fusion is complete. Cool, and transfer the fused mixture to a dish or beaker with the aid of about 50 ml. of hot water. Add hydrochloric acid to the liquid until effervescence ceases, then add 10 ml. more of the acid, and evaporate the mixture on a steam bath to dryness. Cool; add 20 ml. of water; boil; and filter the mixture: an insoluble residue of silica shall remain. Dissolve the filtrate about 2 g. of ammonium chloride, and add 5 ml. of 10 percent ammonia solution. Filter if necessary, and add one normal sodium phosphate solution to filtrate: a white crystalline precipitate of magnesium ammonium phosphate shall separate. If an insoluble residue of silica fails to remain or a white crystalline precipitate of magensium ammonium phosphate fails to separate, this test is a failure.

4.4.2 *pH.* Boil 10 g. of the sample in 50 ml. of water for 30 minutes, then filter and test the filtrate with both red litmus and blue litmus papers.

4.4.3 *Loss on ignition.* Weigh accurately 1 g. of the test sample in a tared platinum crucible provided with a cover. Gradually apply heat to crucible, then ignite at red heat to constant weight.

4.4.3.1 *Calculation.*

$$\text{Percent loss on ignition} = \frac{\text{Weight loss}}{\text{Sample weight}} \times 100.$$

4.4.4 *Fineness (coarse particles).* Dry a No. 200 sieve and a No. 100 sieve in an oven at 105° to 110°C. Cool the sieves and weigh. Moisten 30 g. of the talcum powder with alcohol and then add 100 ml. of water. Wash this mixture through the No. 100 sieve onto and through the No. 200 sieve using a gentle stream of water and stirring gently with a camel's hair brush until no more of the talcum powder passes through either sieve. Dry the sieves at 105° to 110° C. for one hour, cool, and weigh. Based on the increase in the weight if each sieve and the weight of the sample, calculate the percent of talcum powder retained on each sieve.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Talcum podwer shall be packaged in 12 or 16-ounce quantities in cans or plastic containers (unit container), at the option of the contractor.

5.1.1.1 *Cans.* Talcum powder shall be packaged in 12 or 16-ounce quantities, as specified (see 6.2), in cans (unit container) of appropriate size conforming to type V, class 7 of PPP-C-96. Can closure shall be a revolving sifter type. The filled cans shall be packaged in accordance with the appendix of PPP-C-96.

5.1.1.2 *Pastic containers.* Talcum powder shall be packaged in 12 or 16-ounce quantities, as specified (see 6.2), in a high density polyethylene unit container con-

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forming to class 2, style 2, closure "O" (two-piece medium density polyethylene snapon plastic sifter cap size 43 m/n), in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-C-186. The wall of the unit container shall be not less than 0.010-inch in thickness. The cap shall have a minimum of five holes and each hole shall be 0.0760-inch diameter plus or minus 0.002-inch. Twelve filled plastic containers shall be packaged in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety SW, or type SF, class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.2 *Level C.* Talcum powder shall be packaged in 12 or 16-ounce quantities, as specified (see 6.2), and to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Twenty-four talcum powder cans or plastic containers, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Closure, waterproofing by means of tape, and reinforcing with flat steel strapping or tape banding, shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Twenty-four talcum powder cans or plastic containers, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF, variety SW, or type SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Talcum powder, packaged as specified in 5.1; shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military requirements.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4 Standard pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in 5.1.1.1, 5.1.1.2, and 5.2.2 (see 6.4).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The talcum powder covered by this specification is intended for general comfort use.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Whether a preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(*c*) Whether a color sample will be furnished (see 3.4).
(*d*) Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(*e*) Unit quantities of powder required (see 5.1.1 and 5.1.2).

6.3 Standard pack (civil agencies). The standard pack for this commodity shall be as specified in 5.4. The standard pack requirements are intended for use in procurement of stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard

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pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or immediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue, and/or shipment to eventual user.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:
Army—GL
Navy—SA

Review activities:
Army—GL, MD
Navy—SA

User activity:
Marine Corps—MC

Preparing activity:
Army—GL

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